

Why Every Successful Guy Is Secretly On Drugs

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 19, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ibefBI2jcQs> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter reveals six "cheat codes" used by high-performing entrepreneurs — covering focus drugs, GLP-1 appetite suppressants, testosterone replacement, personal brand fame, multi-pillar attraction, and an extreme "must-have" execution mindset.

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Cheat Code #1: Modafinil & Adderall for Focus 1:12

- Every high-level entrepreneur Brandon knows is on some form of PED or nootropic — he says he "can't name one who's not"
 - They appear to do far more than normal people; the explanation, per Brandon, is pharmaceutical assistance
 - He stresses this isn't medical advice and to consult a doctor before doing anything
- **Modafinil** — the daily, controllable tool
 - Analogy: if Adderall is "putting your foot all the way on the gas," Modafinil is "taking your foot off the brake"
 - Mechanism: blocks the brain receptors/chemicals that make you tired; eliminates mild chronic lethargy
 - Result: increased focus and energy without the intensity spike of Adderall
 - Brandon took it nearly every day during the year he made his first million
 - No withdrawal symptoms when skipping a day — he'd skip for family events without issue
 - It is an anti-narcolepsy medication, often prescribed off-label
 - Best use case: chronic, everyday focus deficits — "sustained grinding"
- **Adderall** — the emergency tool only
 - It is an amphetamine; creates a dramatic, god-like surge in productivity and energy
 - "In case of emergency, break glass, take the Adderall"

- Highly addictive; skipping a day after chronic use causes withdrawal symptoms
- Brandon now takes it less than once a month — strictly for emergencies (e.g., functioning after a night up with his infant son)
- Critical rule: **have everything set up and be ready to work BEFORE you take it**
 - Story: took it before "quickly" cleaning his home office → spent the whole day cleaning instead of working
 - Story: took it, then opened a twerk video on YouTube → spent 8 hours watching twerk videos
- It is a Schedule II controlled substance (harder to get prescribed than Modafinil)
- How to decide which you need — Brandon's recommended self-assessment:
 - Track your focus hour by hour (or every two hours) for 7 days straight
 - Note when and why your brain checks out
 - Chronic, everyday problem → Modafinil is the appropriate tool
 - Two or three bad days per month only → you don't need a daily medication; Adderall on those specific days
- Disclaimer on over-the-counter nootropics (Alpha GPC, Lion's Mane): "That's amateur hour" — they work somewhat, but they're what people recommend to avoid talking about the real drugs
- All of Brandon's prescriptions come from a licensed physician through a legitimate pharmacy

Cheat Code #2: Tirzepatide (Zepbound) for Fat Loss & Focus [6:34](#)

- Brandon is on his **fourth week** of Tirzepatide at the time of filming and describes it as the easiest cut of his life — he has been bulking and cutting since age 16
- Primary effect: **complete appetite suppression** — food "doesn't even cross my mind"
- Side benefit he personally noticed: significantly increased focus
 - Has not taken Adderall or Modafinil during this cut at all
 - Theory: not thinking about food frees up cognitive bandwidth
- Dosage: **2.5 mg injected once per week**; planning to drop to 2 mg because appetite suppression is almost too strong
- The challenge: still must hit **200 grams of protein per day** to preserve muscle — requires deliberate effort when appetite is gone
 - Solution: set alarms to drink pre-made protein shakes
 - Currently eating only **1,500–1,700 calories per day**, causing him to appear slightly flatter
 - Plans to fix with one high-calorie refeed day
- **Macro tracking is mandatory on GLP-1s** — you will not accidentally eat enough protein; without tracking, muscle loss is near-certain
- Strong warning against getting it from unregulated sources (black market, sketchy websites, gym guys):
 - Drug dealers "step on" (cut/dilute) products to stretch supply — a gym source or a Chinese website has zero oversight and every incentive to do the same

- Brandon says he will not inject anything not sourced from a licensed pharmacy
- Note: Retatrutide ("Rea") cannot currently be obtained from a doctor; Tirzepatide can be

Cheat Code #3: Testosterone Replacement Therapy (TRT) 10:03

- Hormones — specifically testosterone — determine drive, energy, and motivation
- **For men under 35: maximize natural testosterone first**
 - Get under **15% body fat** (above 15%, testosterone begins declining and estrogen rises)
 - Sleep **7–8 hours per night** (track with Oura Ring, Apple Watch, or Loop)
 - Heavy compound lifts
 - Get enough **vitamin D** — at least **2,000 IUs/day**, especially for Black and Latino men
 - Melanin-rich skin was designed for equatorial sun exposure; most people are indoors and deficient
 - Side note: this vitamin D deficiency (not cold temperatures) is why people get sick more in winter — more time indoors, less sun, immune system lowered, more germ spread in shared spaces
 - Adequate dietary fat and cholesterol (the body needs fat/cholesterol to produce testosterone)
 - Keep cortisol low
- **For men over 35: also get tested**
 - Men's testosterone naturally begins declining at age 30
 - Brandon's experience: doing everything right but felt tired, lethargic, and unmotivated approaching age 40
 - Testosterone tested at ~400–500 ng/dL at age ~39
 - Testosterone was ~1,200 ng/dL in his 20s
 - Tried dietary fixes first (came off keto, added carbs) — felt worse
 - Notes newer studies suggest ketogenic diet actually raises testosterone (makes sense given high fat/cholesterol intake)
 - Got on TRT ~5 years ago (just before turning 40) — "one of the best decisions I ever made"
 - Immediate return of drive, energy, and motivation
 - Gained only ~5 lbs of muscle over 5 years — TRT is not steroids
- **Brandon's TRT sweet spot: ~900 ng/dL**
 - When higher: too aggressive, too much libido, became a "liability" in his personal life
 - At 900: calm, focused, high drive, able to function normally in society
 - TRT is meant to restore natural levels, not exceed them
- TRT vs. steroids distinction: steroids push testosterone far higher and produce dramatically more muscle; TRT simply replaces what was lost to aging
- Warned about men who clearly overdose on TRT and produce what he calls "midlife crisis content" — suddenly hyper-alpha, cigar-smoking, lecturing others about masculinity

- Reported side effect: can lower sperm count; may need to pause to conceive (Brandon joked this was a feature, not a bug)
- **Free tool: RIP Roadmap** — input height, weight, age, and a photo; it analyzes body fat %, tells you how much fat to lose to hit your target, and gives exact daily calorie and macro targets with adjustable carb/fat split. Link in description.

🌟 **Cheat Code #4: Get Famous — Build a Personal Brand 18:55**

- Fame is the "ultimate leverage" — it improves business, relationships, and dating simultaneously
- Brandon's personal reach: ~1M Instagram followers, ~1M YouTube subscribers, ~1M Facebook followers, ~500K TikTok followers
- Built several multi-million dollar businesses almost entirely off his personal brand; has ~30 employees
- Example: best friend Jeremy Haye (runs a mastermind for entrepreneurs doing millions/month) found Brandon through an old YouTube video called "Excuses Off" during a personal low point — that relationship opened major doors
- Status is one of the **three pillars of attraction** (Looks, Money, Status) — high status means people pursue you, not the other way around
- **Fastest way to grow a following:**
 - Focus exclusively on **short-form content** — TikTok, Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts
 - Long-form video takes a very long time to gain traction; start there only after building an audience
 - Post **at minimum once per day**; best students post **six times per day**
 - CEO of Instagram has stated: the more you post, the more you grow
- **Method 1 — Niche Hacking:**
 - Go to Instagram search and type your niche
 - Look for **outliers** — videos with 5–10× more views than the creator has followers (e.g., 1M views on a 100K-follower account)
 - Do NOT copy large creators (their views may just be from their audience size)
 - Download the outlier video; copy its **structure** (not its words or content)
 - Remix with your own words, stories, and experience
 - This strategy 5× a student's following in under 3 months
 - Analogy: like learning guitar — you first learn existing songs (Beatles, BB King, Muddy Waters) before composing your own
- **Method 2 — AI Content Tool:**
 - Free tool: **Viral Content Architect** (link in description)
 - Input your niche, target market, and platform → instantly generates 10–20 video ideas plus an outline/bullet-point script
 - Do NOT have AI write the full script (sounds robotic/"content slop"); use the outline as structure and fill it with your own knowledge and experience
- Commitment: post every day for 3 months = ~90–100 videos; some will hit big

- With a business behind the brand, clients will follow



Cheat Code #5: Don't Max Out Just One Pillar of Attraction 24:17

- The **three pillars of attraction**: Looks, Money, Status
- Maxing only one pillar attracts only women who value that one thing:
 - Money only → attracts gold diggers
 - Looks only → attracts superficial women seeking short-term interactions; not high-quality long-term partners
 - Status only (without the others) → incomplete
- **The goal**: be the man she would want even if he were broke, who also has money → "Prince Charming"
- Brandon's personal example: was signed to one of New York's biggest modeling agencies; walked in New York Fashion Week; appeared on billboards and magazine covers — was objectively attractive. Yet the women that attracted were largely shallow and low-quality.
 - "Father Time is undefeated" — looks fade; if that was your only asset, you have nothing left at 43
- There is also a **fourth pillar: Character/Substance**
 - Intellect, humor, great personality — being someone people genuinely love to be around
 - Required to attract AND keep top-tier women
- If a woman is settling for you (because you're missing a pillar), she will give you more friction and harbor mild resentment; she won't behave the same as she would with her "dream guy"
- **The Drake Test**:
 - When someone flakes, ghosts, or doesn't prioritize you — ask: "Would they have done this to Drake?"
 - Drake = near-billionaire, extremely high status, relatively attractive, globally famous → almost no one would flake on Drake
 - The answer is always no → that's your feedback, not a reason to be bitter
 - It means: "I'm not that guy yet — and that's okay, because I can improve"
 - Use every slight, flake, or non-response as **data for self-improvement**, not fuel for bitterness or resentment
 - "Extreme success can only come from extreme action" — constant improvement is the response



Cheat Code #6: You Don't Get What You Want, You Get What You Have to Have 30:47

- Story: Brandon met his late friend Connor Murphy at a restaurant; both independently pulled out **digital food scales** at the table — instantly bonded over identical commitment to tracking
 - When Brandon asked Connor what he does when he misses his macros, Connor was bewildered: "That doesn't happen. I hit my goals every day because it's a **must**."

"You don't get what you want. You get what you have to have."

- Every goal you failed to achieve was just a "want" or a "good idea" — not a must
- **The framework:**
 - Take the three pillars of life: **Health, Wealth, Relationships**
 - Pick **one goal** for each (just one per pillar)
 - Make a plan — but don't ask "what do I have to do to accomplish this?"
 - Instead ask: **"What amount of effort would make failure impossible?"**
 - Then put in that amount of effort
 - The result: mathematical certainty of success, not just an attempt
- Brandon and Connor tracked every single thing they ate for over a decade → physique goals were guaranteed, not attempted
- The plan will evolve; that's fine — the level of effort must remain unreasonable
 - "It should look like mania to everyone else"
 - When people say "you're going too hard," "that's too much," "I could never do that" → those are **"mediocre mantras"** and confirmation you're on the right path
 - Bringing a food scale to a restaurant and tracking every meal = people think it's crazy → it's exactly right
- **Free tool: Victory Vision Planner** — a free Notion template (Notion is also free)
 - Tab 1: Daily habit tracker — fill in habits needed to hit your goals
 - Tab 2: Goal planning with instructions
 - Link in description
- Call to action: like the video, subscribe, share with a friend, download all three free resources (RIP Roadmap, Viral Content Architect, Victory Vision Planner)